

disturbed Elgar's marriage.

In 1912, the Elgars moved to London. They led a life of theater-going and dinner parties. Elgar's music was then developing toward inwardness. A listening public expecting simpler pleasures was disappointed. Elgar said of an unresponsive audience at the premiere of his Second Symphony at the Queen's Hall, London, in 1911, "they just sat there like stuffed pigs."

He reacted to the outbreak of World War I in 1914 with horror, and was appalled at the jingoistic exploitation of his "Land of Hope and Glory." In 1917, he withdrew to an isolated house in Sussex, where he wrote his Cello Concerto, a masterpiece of elegiac sadness and piercing nostalgia. It was his last finished work. Alice died in 1920; Elgar's creative drive died with her.